

JAWS OF DEATH

OTODUS

Menacing every ocean on Earth, *Otodus* was a terrifyingly large shark. Commonly referred to by its species name, *megalodon*, *Otodus* had huge jaws lined with razor-sharp teeth that made it a formidable ocean hunter. Scientists think it may have gone extinct in part due to the presence of a famous marine predator that prowls modern-day oceans: the great white shark. Evolving around the same time as *Otodus*, the great white probably outcompeted young *Otodus* sharks for food, driving the larger species toward extinction.

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 33–59 ft (10–18 m)
- **DIET** Carnivore
- **LIVED** 15.9–3.2 MYA
- **HABITAT** Oceans



**STRONGEST
BITE: SHARK**

STATS AND FACTS

Otodus's large size meant it had a monstrous bite force. Scientists think that the bone-crushing bite of this predator was likely to be 10 times stronger than that of the great white shark—the most powerful predatory shark alive today.

WEIGHT



An adult *Otodus* may have weighed as much as 55 tons (50 tonnes).

SPEED



Otodus could swim at around 11 mph (18 kph), which is a similar speed to some modern whales.

